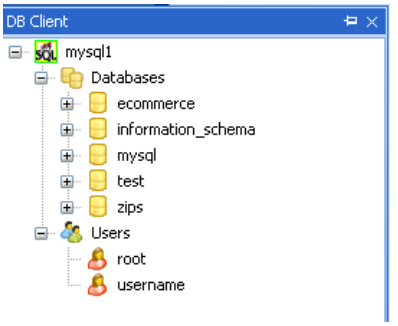
speed and reliability over PHP 3. In terms of features, PHP 4 added references, the Boolean type, COM support on Windows, output buffering, many new array functions, expanded object-oriented programming, inclusion of the PCRE library, and more. Maintenance releases of PHP 4 are still available, primarily for security updates.



Keyword

Interpreter is a computer program that directly executes, i.e. performs, instructions written in a programming or scripting language, without requiring them previously to have been compiled into a machine language program.

PHP 5 was released in July 2004, with the updated Zend Engine 2.0. Among the many new features in PHP 5 are:

- improved object-oriented programming
- embedded SQLite
- support for new MySQL features (see the image at right)
- exception handling using a try..catch structure
- integrated SOAP support (see the image at right)
- the Filter library (in PHP 5.1)
- better XML tools
- iterators

and much, much more.

